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HIVE Lab

Health Informatics, Visualization, and Equity



Institute of Health Policy, Management and Evaluation

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HANDLING OURS



In a dataset where you are clustering health metrics of individuals, how might outliers impact **K-means** clustering?

“Answer: Outliers can exert significant influence on the centroid of a K -means cluster, potentially distorting its representation. When dealing with health metrics, which frequently include extreme values, it is advisable to consider either excluding outliers or employing clustering algorithms designed to handle them more robustly.”

HANDLING OUTLIERS

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SCALING AND DIMENSIONALITY

Why might you need to be careful with variables of **different scales** (e.g., income in thousands and age in years) when clustering public health data with K-means?

